

CHOOSING A LAPTOP **FOR HOME** WITHIN ₹ 35,000



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Modern laptops come in many form factors and performance capacities. As computing components like processors and RAM have improved tremendously, powerful laptops at reasonable prices have become widely available. In this article we look at the features and capabilities that a laptop should possess to deliver the optimal usage experience to home users for daily purposes.

Features to look for

Features required in a laptop depend on its extent of use. For basic home use like Web brows-

ing and media streaming, almost all available market options are quite capable, because of strong processing and memory capabilities. What creates the difference is the laptop's capacity to support heavy-load operations or to multitask.

As a home user, the first parameter you should look at is the display and build. The screen should ideally be of at least 1920x1080 pixels, full-HD resolution, with a high width and aspect ratio. It is recommended to choose a laptop of at least 38.1cm (15-inch) screen size.

Since the main purpose of a laptop is portability, select a device that is lightweight (ideally not more than 1.7 kilograms) and slim. For ease of use, keys should be big, and area covered by the keyboard should be comfortably wide. The trackpad should have decent sensitivity.

Revisiting our earlier discussion, the capacity of a laptop to take on heavy

computing load depends on its components. An Intel i3 7th-generation dual-core processor or an equivalent AMD processor can be a decent deal for a mid-budget laptop. At least 4GB RAM should be selected—expandability of RAM is an added advantage.

Most mid-budget laptops come with inbuilt storage of 1TB HDD. The laptops should be Wi-Fi- and Bluetooth-compliant, too. A high number of USB and Ethernet ports are desirable. Some laptops may contain SD card slots and DVD readers as well.

Battery is a critical feature of laptops. Go for a high battery capacity (denoted in Watt-hours, or Wh). Speakers can also be tested during purchase. Many laptops come with Windows 10 pre-installed (may cost more), while others come with Linux. Finally, go for the deal with the highest warranty coverage—most vendors provide one-year warranty.

Market options

Mentioned below are some popular choices available in the market. We have restricted our budget to ₹ 35,000 for the purpose of home laptops.

HP Notebook 15-da0326tu. This mid-range laptop from HP comes with



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